Gerri Cole

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

With over 25 years of experience in software engineering, I bring a strong blend of technical expertise and leadership. I've worked extensively in both Azure and AWS cloud environments, supporting cloud-native applications and scalable infrastructure. In recent roles as a Release Engineer, I've led organization-wide CI/CD pipeline conversions and standardizations, streamlined release processes through automation and SDLC tool integrations (Jira, GitHub, Harness, etc.), and developed cross-platform release metrics to drive continuous improvement. Passionate about optimizing developer workflows, enhancing system reliability, and delivering high-impact engineering solutions.

EDUCATION

Virginia Tech
Master of Information Technology, with graduate certificates in Software Engineering and Cyber Security Technologies
GPA: 4.0 **August 2024**

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Scrum Master SixSigma **January 2023**
Azure Fundamentals **February 2023**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Release Engineer (DevOps Engineer) Campspot *Grand Rapids, MI - Remote* 7-2023 – 4-2025

Technologies Used:
AWS, Harness, Build Kite, Bash, Java, Kotlin, REST, Kubernetes, GitHub, YAML, Terraform, Jira/Jira Automation, JIB, Gradle, Maven

- **Release Process Optimization –** Streamlined the release process by implementing Jira automations and integrating Jira, GitHub, and Harness, reducing manual steps by over 66% and cutting compliance reporting time by 75%. Authored process documentation to ensure consistency across products.
- **Pipeline Migration and Standardization –** Delivered full conversion of deployment pipelines from Buildkite to Harness ahead of schedule. Established cross-product standards for redeployment, secrets management, Jira integration and Honeycomb markers, improving security, traceability, and developer experience.
- **Release Metrics and Reporting –** Developed comprehensive reporting pulling from Jira, Harness and Buildkite to track release frequency, hotfix rates, issue volume, and other KPIs. Enabled data-driven decisions to improve release reliability and efficiency.
- **Build Optimization –** Enhanced pipeline performance by adopting JIB for image building and leveraging Harness Build Intelligence and caching. Achieved up to 50% reduction in compile times across multiple pipelines.

Team Lead DevOps/Lead Software Engineer H&R Block *Kansas City, MO - Remote* 5-1995 – 7-2023

Technologies Used:
Azure, C#, Azure Pipelines, YAML, Terraform, Kubernetes, Microservices, Power Shell, TFS, GitHub, Team City, Delphi, C++, InstallShield

- **CI/CD Pipeline Development for Cloud-Native App -** Led the team in developing CI/CD pipelines and environments for a new cloud-native tax preparation application, supporting 80+ microservices deployed in AKS and as Azure Functions within an App Service environment. This included integration with SonarQube and automated API testing.
- **Infrastructure Automation with Terraform Enterprise -** Led the team in transitioning the infrastructure build-out process from manual configuration in Azure Portal to Terraform Enterprise, resulting in an 85% reduction in time to create new environments.

- **Cloud Cost Optimization & Resource Governance -** Monitored costs across environments for the new tax preparation system and partnered with the team to eliminate unused infrastructure, achieving a 50% reduction. Implemented checkpoints and standardized processes to enable more proactive resource management.
- **Legacy Build System Modernization -** Converted legacy Team City build process to Azure pipelines for desktop tax preparation, including move from TFS to GIT. The overall build time decreased by 75%.
- **Desktop Installation –** Converted existing install process to a headless installation process that allowed for unattended installation and software updates across the 10,000 tax offices, resulting in a times savings in each of the tax offices of at least an hour a day for each day during tax season.